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Bazaar

Apple iPhone SE

The last of them

The Apple iPhone SE was much anticipated, buoyed by the prospect of a compact form factor and powerful hardware combined with the widely popular design implemented in older generation iPhones. Delivering just that, the iPhone SE is unrecognisably iPhone 5s on the outside, and arguably equal to (or maybe slightly better than) the iPhone 6s. Display-wise, it gets a 4-inch Retina panel that is as good as ever, with crisp, sharp contrast levels and excellent viewing angles. The latest addition of Night Shift in iOS 9.3 also makes it more convenient to view in dark environments.

The display itself, no matter how good it is, presents the biggest question mark over the iPhone SE. In today's world of video-oriented entertainment services and graphic-intensive mobile gaming, the world has moved on to an average screen size of 5 inches. In such a world, a 4-inch screen will definitely seem too small for anyone presently using a larger display. For existing iPhone users, it only makes sense for people who still use iPhone 4/4s, but for others, it just does not have the same impact of upgrading a smartphone that you would hope for. It is still excellent, but the 4-inch size does feel restricting now. It takes extra swipes to read a story, and while that may not immediately impact you, it will, eventually.

Performance-wise, the iPhone SE is excellent. Powered by the Apple A9 processor with 2GB of memory, the iPhone SE delivers flawless performance and multitasking. Daily sustenance apps (Facebook, WhatsApp, Mail, etc.) load without any hint of stutters, and gaming is a delight, too. The hexa-core PowerVR GT7600 GPU is powerful, and combined with the smaller screen size, has lesser display area to drive, thereby leading to higher frame rates. Hence, games rich in graphics look absolutely brilliant. Hardly ever will you notice any stutter, even when you multitask with a number of apps open. With its metal build, the iPhone SE does heat up slightly when you run intensive tasks on it for prolonged sessions, but the heat is manageable and nothing major to worry about. Call



Price
₹39,000

performance is clear and apt, and network retention is also excellent.

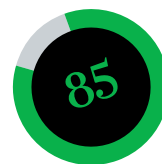
The camera module uses the same, 12MP Sony IMX315 image sensor as the iPhone 6s, and gets integrated 4K video recording and Live Photos. There is no OIS here, and even the noise-reduction algorithms do not seem great. As a result, while it preserves the trademark of iPhone photos with good colour accuracy, the noise somewhat spoils the party in certain situations. It is definitely good, but unfortunately not good enough to compete with the top-of-the-line flagships like the Samsung Galaxy S7 lineup. Head over to our review online to check out sample shots. The front camera has remained the same, although it does get Retina Flash. Apple did not advertise it the way it did with the iPhone 6s, but while it may not be a major influencing factor here, it comes

surprisingly handy at times.

Battery life has still remained a major spot of concern. The iPhone SE survived for only about 4 hours and 30 minutes on Geekbench battery benchmark, and even in real life, it can last for about 12 hours at best. You will almost certainly require a power bank to feel assured. iOS 9.3 runs much smoother, and the cohesive iPhone experience sustains here. Apple had spoken about the iPhone SE getting a larger battery pack than the iPhone 5s, which should have made it better than the iPhone 5s in terms of battery stamina. That, though, is not exactly a benchmark to go by anyway, and the iPhone SE falls in the lower rung of battery stamina for mobile devices.

The pricing in India, however, spells death knell. At ₹39,000, the iPhone 6s is only a few grand more. The iPhone SE would still have made good sense had it been around the 30k margin, but at this price, only a very select few would prefer this over the iPhone 6s. It is indeed an excellent flagship, and possibly the last ever 4-inch flagship smartphone, but it may not sell as much as Apple would like it to. At least, that's what we think.

Souvik Das



Features 75
Design 90
Performance 85
Value for Money 67

Specifications

Processor: Apple A9, **RAM:** 2GB, **Storage:** 16GB/64GB, **Camera:** 12MP iSight, **Battery:** 1642mAh

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